OUR HISTORY

URISA's GISCorps provides short-term volunteer GIS services to organizations and communities in need around the world. Since 2003, GISCorps has launched hundreds of missions supporting nonprofit organizations and disaster response in 80+ countries. From humanitarian relief to public health to conservation, GISCorps volunteers do GIS for Good where it's needed most.

New & Ongoing Projects
Completed Projects
GIS Service Pledge Projects
HOT Projects
Projects by Type
- Animal Welfare
- Application Development
- Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning
- Capacity Building
- Cartography
- Conservation
- Crowdsourcing
- Cultural Resources
- Data Collection/Creation
- Data Mining
- Disaster Response
- Environmental
- GIS Consulting
- GSDI
- HOT/OSM
- Humanitarian Response
- Image processing/analysis
- K-12 Education
- Natural Resources
- Needs Assessment
- Open Source
- Public Health
- Public Safety
- Remote Sensing
- Social Justice
- Social Media
- Spatial Analysis
- Spatial Data Processing and Quality Control
- Sustainability
- System Architecture
- Training
- User Support
- Web GIS

Donate

October 2001

URISA Annual Conference, Long Beach, Calif...

URISA Board Member Ed Wells, invites Shoreh Elhami to serve on URISA's International Task Force (ITF).

September 2002

ITF Taskforce Report

Shoreh submits a report to the ITF task force on possible roles that ITF could take. GISCorps and its roles were listed in that document.

October 2002

October 2002 URISA Annual Conference, Chi...

Shoreh shares the idea with more URISA members including Sanjiv Gandhi, Martha Lombard, Tom Conry (the Core Committee members at the time) and with several GIS Industry leaders such as Jack Dangermond.

November 2002 – March 2003

GISCorps Summary Page

Shoreh and Ed work on a summary page on GISCorps and share it with several Board and general members of URISA.

April 2003

First GISCorps Website Launched

URISA's staff creates the GISCorps web site under URISA's main site. The on line Volunteers Application form is débuted and Shoreh signs up as the first volunteer!

May 2003 - July 2003

Friends of the GISCorps (FOG) database

Shoreh starts compiling a database of Friends of the GISCorps (FOG) and volunteers. By July 2003, 26 volunteers have joined the GISCorps. The first article on GISCorps is published in URISA's Newsletter.

July 2003

ESRI Users Conference, San Diego California.

Shoreh presents the project to an enthusiastic audience at a users meeting arranged by ESRI. Many of the attendees are already GISCorps volunteers, such as Juna Papajorgji. Shoreh also presents the GISCorps to three other user groups and meets with several GIS Industry leaders. Arc-News publishes a news bit on GISCorps.

August 2003

Donation from University of Florida, Departm...

University of Florida, Department of Urban and Regional Planning, makes the first donation to the GISCorps idea, via Juna Goda Papajorgji.

September 2003

Donation from Alachua County, Florida, Prop...

Alachua County, Florida, Property Appraisers, makes the second donation to the GISCorps idea, via the Honorable Ed Crapo.

October 2003

GISCorps Overall Plan

Shoreh, Ed, Juna, Martha, Sanjiv, and Tom work on an overall plan for GISCorps in a power point slide show. This is presented to URISA's Board of Directors on October 15th. The Board of Directors unanimously endorses the GISCorps as an initiative under URISA's auspices. In the following days using the power point slides, Shoreh and Juna discuss GISCorps with the conference audience. The number of volunteers increases to 41.

November 2003

Core Committee of GISCorps formed

The Core Committee of GISCorps is formed. The Core Committee is charged with developing a Strategic Plan (SP) and an Operation Plan (OP). Committee members are:

Shoreh Elhami, GIS Director, Delaware County Auditor – Adjunct Instructor, Ohio State University, City and Regional Planning Department

Juna Papajorgji, GIS Manager, Alachua County – Adjunct Instructor, University of Florida, Urban and Regional Planning Department

Ed Wells, GIS Consultant, Geo-Decisions, Washington D.C.

Martha Lombard, URISA Past President – President, Spatial Focus, Birmingham, AL

Tom Conry, GIS Manager, Fairfax County, VA

Sanjiv Gandhi, IT Manager, City of Orlando, FL

January 2004

Strategic and of Operational Plan reviewed

A draft of the Strategic and of Operational Plan is reviewed by Elaine Whitehead (former URISA Board member) and by Dan Parr (URISA President).

April 2004

GISCorps Core Committee elections

The GISCorps Core Committee elects Shoreh Elhami as its Chair and Juna Papajorgji as its Co-chair. Martha Lombard presents the Strategic Plan and the Operational Plan draft to URISA's Board.

June 15, 2004

GISCorps Website launches

First day on the net for GISCorps.

December 2004

BAAMA Chapter of URISA

BAAMA Chapter of URISA , in California, endorses GISCorps.

March 2005

Alberta Chapter of URISA endorses GISCorps.

Post 2005 activities are included in "Our Projects" webpage.

Have an idea for using your GIS skills to support a nonprofit you love? Take the GIS Service Pledge!

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